[INCH-POUND]

A-A-580A
January 15, 1992
SUPERSEDING
A-A-580
September 26, 1979

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

LEAD HOLDER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for the use of all federal agencies.

This description covers lead holders for drawing and drafting use.

Type I - with adjustable indicator for 17 lead hardness degrees.
Type II - with color coding (cap, ring, or other method) for lead identification.
Type III - without lead hardness indicator.

I. Salient Characteristics:

A. Lead holders shall consist of a barrel which contains a lead holding (clutch) mechanism and chamber and pocket clip. A finger grip shall be located at the writing end of the barrel.

B. Lead holder shall operate by push button action to propel the lead in short, uniform increments to a usable length from the point, and shall operate smoothly and easily, without binding, bending, breaking or other malfunction.

C. Lead holding mechanism (clutch) shall grip the lead firmly, without breaking, so that lead does not turn or slip into or out of the holder. The pencil shall be capable of dispensing the specified lead.

D. Lead shall not fall free from the lead holder when the push button is depressed such that the lead when reduced to a length of as small as 0.5 inches will continue to be retained in the lead holder.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7520

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:09Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

E. The clutch and barrel mechanism shall accept and firmly hold the lead 5 inches long and 0.070 to 0.080 inch in diameter or as specified in the purchase order. (see notes - Section VIII).

G. Workmanship. Lead holders shall be securely assembled so that parts do not become loose or displaced and shall be free from defects or imperfections which may adversely affect appearance or serviceability.

II. Performance A minimum of three leads, of the applicable size, shall be propelled through the lead holder by operating the push button action, and intermittently performing line drawing and writing actions, without the jamming, falling out, breaking, or failing to feed smoothly. The leads used for this test shall be identical to those supplied with the item.

III. Regulatory requirements. The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

IV. Hazardous material requirements.

A. Toxicity. Use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any known carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed Std. 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the pencil conforms to the above requirements.

B. Material safety data sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

C. Labeling. Containers shall be labeled to comply with the "Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations", 16 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

V. Quality assurance requirements.

A. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see VIII), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:09Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

B. Lot definition. Each lot of pencils shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the sampling plans specified below. The lot shall be expressed in pencils manufactured from the same materials, at essentially the same time.

C. Examination of the end item for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one pencil. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any pencil containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

Examine	Defects
Workmanship	See Workmanship paragraph
Appearance	Not as specified
Material	Not as specified
Indicator	Not as specified
Barrel shape	Not as specified

D. Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one pencil. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-2. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any pencil containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

The examination for the characteristics listed in the following table will be based on the specifications/requirements listed in NOTES (see section (see VIII. B.) for the specific pencil being examined.

Examine	Defects
Length (lead capacity)	Not as specified
Diameter (lead capacity)	Not as specified

E. Tests. Sampling for performance testing shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one pencil.

Examine	Defects
Performance Test	Does not comply

F. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container inspected for conformance with the requirements of section VI.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:09Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

VI. Preparation for delivery.

A. Packaging, and packing. Packaging, and packing shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII). The normal commercial number of unit packages shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box used commercially for this item and provide product protection against loss and damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage. The complete pack shall be in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification and the National Motor Freight Classification. The weight of the shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

B. Marking. Marking shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII).

1. For Shipment To Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

2. For Shipment To Military activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

3. Additional marking. The shipping containers shall include any precautionary marking required by the National Motor Freight Classification Item 222, Uniform Freight Classification Rule 41, and Department of Transportation regulations.

VII. Applicable documents.

The following documents, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

A. Public Law and Code of Federal Regulations:

Code of Federal Regulations and Federal Acquisition Regulations are for sale by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Public Law 94-580 - Use of Recovered Materials

16 CFR Part 1500 - Federal Hazardous Substances Labeling Act.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:09Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

B. National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent:

Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W. Washington, D.C., 20036.

National Motor Freight Classification

C. Uniform Classification Committee Agent:

Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.

Uniform Freight Classification

E. Federal Standards, Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions:

Federal standards and specifications are available from GSA Business Service Centers and Specification and Consumer Information Distribution Section, Building 197, Washington Navy Yard, Washington DC 20407.

Single copies of this specification and other specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Washington.

FED-STD-123 Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)

FED-STD-313 Material Safety Data, Transportation Data and Disposal Data for Hazardous Materials Furnished to Government Activities.

F. Military Standards:

Military Standards are available from the Standardization Documents Order Dept., Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:09Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

VIII. Notes.

A. Ordering information. Purchasers shall select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

1. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
2. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified (see tests and quality assurance requirements.)
3. Purchasers shall specify packaging and packing, any special marking for shipment required, if other than required (see preparation for delivery).
4. Identification marking, if other than required.
5. If bar code marking is not required.
6. MSDS's required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.
7. Purchasers shall specify palletization , if required.
8. Purchasers shall specify the type of lead holder and lead size (length and diameter) required.

B. Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (For classification use, only):

AA580 - A (Describes a Lead holder, type I, in accordance with CID A-A-580A.)

------ Types:
A. Type I
B. Type II
C. Type III

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:09Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.